

Receiving the Best Data Storytelling award at CCIS Innovision 2026 was a humbling recognition of the work we invested in EduGuide's data science component. Our goal was never simply to build a functional system, but to extract meaningful insights from learner data and communicate them clearly through confidence gap analyses, clustering visualizations, and module difficulty indices that translate raw numbers into actionable study guidance.

This experience taught us that data storytelling is not just about accuracy; it is about making complexity accessible. Designing visualizations that a non-technical evaluator could immediately understand required as much iteration as the underlying algorithms themselves. We also learned that honest presentation of limitations, particularly around our synthetic training data, is itself part of good data storytelling.

This award motivates us to carry the same standard of clarity, rigor, and intentional communication into future research and professional work.